

365 Data Science SQL Basics – Topic 2.3: Wildcards & Advanced Lookups

Exhaustive Notes on LIKE Pattern Matching, BETWEEN & NULL Filtering

1. Wildcard Pattern Matching with LIKE

- ``%``: Represents zero or more characters.
- ``_``: Represents exactly one character.

2. BETWEEN and NULL Filtering

- ``BETWEEN min AND max``: Filters values within inclusive range.
- ``IS NULL`` / ``IS NOT NULL``: Filters missing or present values.

```
SELECT * FROM employees
WHERE first_name LIKE 'Mar%'
  AND hire_date BETWEEN '2015-01-01' AND '2020-12-31'
  AND salary IS NOT NULL;
```

3. Topic 2.3 Viva Q&A

1. Q: Can you use `= NULL` to search for missing values? A: No. NULL cannot be evaluated with equality ``=``. You must use ``IS NULL``.